What Dad Lives On Today

A worksheet for what comes in and what goes out each month, as it is now.

Dad's pension and Social Security come in, the bills go out, and it has always worked. Nobody has ever written the two side by side.

Fill this in with Dad, from a recent bank statement and his checkbook instead of from memory. Write each amount as the paperwork shows it, for the month as it is today. If you don't know, write “don't know yet” and leave it.

Account numbers, Social Security numbers and passwords stay off the page. So do projections: this worksheet stops at today.

What comes in each month

Social Security, any pension, and anything else that arrives regularly. For each one, write who pays it, how it arrives, and the amount as the statement shows it.

FOR EXAMPLE Social Security, direct deposit to the credit union, early in the month. Pension from the plant, same account, a few days later. Amounts copied from the March statement.

What goes out every month

The regular bills: housing, utilities, food, the car, the phone, insurance premiums. Write the amount as the statement or the checkbook shows it.

FOR EXAMPLE Electric and gas on automatic payment. Supplemental health plan premium comes out of the same account. Groceries and gas for the truck on the debit card; Dad says it's about the same every month.

What goes out now and then

The bills that come once or twice a year and are easy to miss in a single month's statement: property tax, homeowner's and car insurance, a policy premium paid by check.

FOR EXAMPLE Property tax in two parts, spring and fall. He writes a check for the long-term care policy premium once a year. We didn't know that until we looked.

Where the money comes from when a month runs over

The account Dad turns to for a repair or a larger bill. The name of the account is enough; no balance is needed here.

FOR EXAMPLE Savings account at the same credit union. He moves money across himself when something comes up. Neither of us knows how often.

What we couldn't confirm

Deposits or payments on the statement that nobody can name, and things Dad mentions that have no paperwork yet. Don't guess.

FOR EXAMPLE A payment that leaves the account every month with only initials beside it. Dad thinks it's an old insurance policy. He'll ask the credit union.

Who filled this in, and the date

What this shows you

Three things: what comes in for Dad each month, what goes out, and the lines nobody could confirm. It is a picture of the month as it is today. It doesn't project what care would cost, work out a gap, or estimate how long his resources would last, and nothing here adds up to a score or a level. Those questions, and what any of this means for Medicaid, go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional, because rules vary by state. Nothing here is legal, financial, tax or insurance advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've written what comes in and what goes out for Dad, side by side, as it is today. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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